

Topic 6: Infection, immunity and forensics

This topic starts by looking at how forensic pathologists use a wide variety of analytical techniques to determine the identity of a person or other animal, and to establish the time and cause of death of an organism, including humans. It then considers how bacteria and viruses use a variety of routes into their hosts and how hosts have evolved barriers and internal mechanisms to combat infections. These protections are not always successful and many people in the world still die from infectious diseases. This topic also investigates the evolutionary battles that take place between invading pathogens and their hosts.

3.2 Assessment information

This unit is assessed by means of a written examination paper, which carries 90 marks, lasts 1 hour 30 minutes and will include:

- objective questions
- structured questions
- short-answer questions

and will also cover:

- *How Science Works*
- practical-related questions.

Students may use a calculator.

The quality of written communication will be assessed in the context of this unit through questions which are labelled with an asterisk (*). Students should take particular care with spelling, punctuation and grammar, as well as the clarity of expression, on these questions.